



ALL-AFRICA STUDENTS UNION
UNION PANAFRICAINNE DES ETUDIANTS
الاتحاد جميع الطلاب الأفريقي
Defending students rights since 1972



DEMOCRACY & GOOD GOVERNANCE
WORKING GROUP



REGIONAL CONFERENCES ON DEMOCRACY AND GOOD GOVERNANCE

CONCEPT NOTE



Headquarters, Accra-Ghana

P.O.Box M274, Accra-Ghana

✉ secgen@aasuonline.org | info@aasuonline.org

🌐 www.aasuonline.org ☎ +233 302 547 128



United Nations Security Council Resolution 2250:

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“.... Recognizing the important and positive contribution of youth in efforts for the maintenance and promotion of peace and security,

Affirming the important role youth can play in the prevention and resolution of conflicts and as a key aspect of the sustainability, inclusiveness and success of peacekeeping and peacebuilding efforts...”

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REGIONAL CONFERENCES ON DEMOCRACY AND GOOD GOVERNANCE

The Regional Conferences on Democracy and Good Governance seeks to engage and sensitise a maximum of 1,500 youth participants from across the African continent on topics of Informal Power versus formal power, Violent extremism and Intolerance and Exclusion. These three main tracks will be discussed at a plenary conference with several side events, which will take place in five countries across the African continent with a final event to climax to harmonise all the outputs.

BACKGROUND

Article 11 of the African Youth charter on Youth Participation is the fulcrum upon which this conference is proposed, it spells out that:

1. Every young person shall have the right to participate in all spheres of society.

2. States Parties shall take the following measures to promote active youth participation in society:

They shall:

a) Guarantee the participation of youth in parliament and other decision-making bodies in accordance with the prescribed laws;

b) Facilitate the creation or strengthening of platforms for youth participation in decision-making at local, national, regional, and continental levels of governance;..

The role of students and the youth in democracy and governance across the length and breadth of the African continent cannot be refuted. From the Arab

Spring in Northern Africa, the ousting of Yahyah Jammeh in the Gambia, The Sudanese protests and The South African Youth movements of the 1970s are but a few of many democratic and governance revolutions ignited by the youth. Suffice to say that the African youth have played both positive and negative roles in governance and democracy and this is the reason why it is necessary to promote positive youth inclusion in good governance and democracy. Empowering the youth positively, in the affairs of governance, will have the ripple effect needed to do away with conflicts and corruption across the continent and position it as a safe haven, for living and doing business. A place where everyone's voice can be heard in governance without fear of threat or intimidation and where businesses can be established and flourish without the need to pay bribes.



OBJECTIVES

The ultimate objective of this initiative is to address and strengthen the implementation of United Nations Security Council Resolution 2250, AU Agenda 2063, Article 11 of the African Youth charter and Sustainable Development Goal 16 to empower and encourage youth participation in good governance and advocacy for democracy.

The specific objectives of the conference are as follow:

- To bring together a network of youth leaders to share experiences and support each other in the advancement of youth inclusion for democracy and good governance.
- Generate a resolution paper with solutions to relevant issues affecting the continent for adoption by organisations such as ECOWAS, AU and the UN.
- Foster regional and continental integration in contribution to the fulfilment of the objectives of the African continental free trade agreement and African unity.

FORMAT OF THE CONFERENCE

Selection of host countries ●

Applications will be put out for interested countries to bid an opportunity to host one of the conferences. Selection of the final five (5) host countries will be purely meritocratic and based on a set of standards to be developed by a competent vetting team.

Final event ●

The final event will take place in a sixth country and it will bring together all the resolutions generated across the five countries. It will also feature opening speeches, plenary and breakout sessions with a twist. Representatives from the five host countries will have the opportunity to debate their ideas from among the tracks and a final resolution will be generated for necessary action.

Conferences ●

Opening speeches from keynote speakers and partner organisations will set the ball rolling followed by plenary and breakout sessions. The breakout sessions will address the three tracks, selected experts from each country will facilitate these sessions and afterwards, the ideas and interventions generated will be teased out into a resolution paper.

Speakers and Participants ●

The opening speeches will feature representatives from partner organisations and the plenary will be made up of four experts on various topics, there will be a moderator to steer affairs. Participants will comprise youth and student leaders, policy makers, AU, ECOWAS, UN, Civil Society and stakeholder NGOs, the goal is to bring together a maximum of 300 participants from each country.



OUTPUT/RESULTS

- Finalised resolution papers will be drawn up for follow-ups and necessary action from stakeholder institutions.
- Videos and transcripts from the conferences will be generated.

PROPOSED PARTNERS



UNESCO



ECOWAS

YALI Alumni
Chapters

COMESA



ECAS



EAC



IGAD



IREX



ASSOCIATION OF AFRICAN UNIVERSITIES
ASSOCIATION DES UNIVERSITES AFRICAINES
اتحاد الجامعات الأفريقية

AAU



Arab Maghreb Union
اتحاد المغرب العربي

AMU



Community of Sahel-Saharan States
مجتمع دول الساحل والصحراء

CEN SAD



**AFRICAN INSTITUTE OF
ARTS SCIENCE &
TECHNOLOGY**

- Ministry of Youth Affairs
- Media Partner(s)

For more information please contact:

Mr Edmund Akoto Bamfo
Chief Technical Officer
All-Africa Students Union
0508244413
eakoto@aasuonline.org

Ms Jessica Arthur
Research Assistant
All-Africa Students Union
0555934982
jarthur@aasuonline.org

ABOUT US

AASU is the largest student movement in Africa and a very dominant force on the Continent and beyond. The All-Africa Students Union (AASU) organizes all students in Africa from the basic level to institutions of higher learning; in essence, the Union is the umbrella organization for all students of Africa. AASU played important role in the struggle against colonialism and the ending of apartheid.

In the year 2000, the UN awarded AASU a certificate of merit in recognition of the Union's efforts at advancing students' rights and championing the democratization of education across the African Continent. See: <http://www.un.org/press/en/2000/20000410.dev2241.doc.html>

AASU is wholly student-run and student-led, autonomous, representative, democratically elected and operates according to democratic principles. The executive structure of the Union is representative of all the sub-regions across the Continent.

AASU's key strength lies in its diversity and numerical strength, which it employs as a bagaining tool to speak for the supreme interests of students at all times. The Union is made up of diverse students, regardless of their religion, gender, cultural background, political persuasion, ethnic origin or social standing.

